TRUMP ANNOUNCES GLOBAL TARIFFS

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Expemo code:
1IN2-F1L3-DAF

1 Warm up

Look at the pictures below. Who do you think is most affected when the global economy struggles? Have you noticed the price of basic goods increasing in your country recently? Do you know anyone who invests their money in the stock market? Do you try to save money every month, or do you usually spend everything you earn? Discuss the questions in pairs.

picture A

picture B

picture C

picture D

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2 Pre-listening task: general vocabulary

Part A: Match words with the correct definitions.

Group 1:

1.	tariff (n)	a.	with no people living there
2.	disruption (n)	b.	fall rapidly in value or amount
3.	uninhabited (adj.)	c.	produce a book, list, report, etc., by bringing together different items, articles, songs, etc.
4.	compile (v)	d.	push, fight or compete with others in order to get or to reach something
5.	tumble (v)	e.	a tax that is paid on goods coming into or going out of a country
6.	scramble (v)	f.	a situation in which it is difficult for something to continue in the normal way

Group 2:

1.	levy (n)	a.	(of an action or decision) done by or affecting only one person, group or country involved in a situation without the agreement of the others
2.	plummet (v)	b.	an extra amount of money that has to be paid, especially as a tax to the government
3.	trade deficit (n)	c.	intended to harm somebody because they harmed you first
4.	unilateral (adj.)	d.	with special permission not to have to do something or pay something
5.	exempt (adj.)	e.	fall suddenly and quickly from a high level or position
6.	retaliatory (adj.)	f.	a situation in which the value of a country's imports is greater than the value of its exports

Part B: Discuss these questions in pairs.

1. Why do you think some countries have a trade deficit with others?
2. Why do you think some people invest in stocks? Is this something you would be interested in doing?
3. If stock prices plummet, how do you think it could affect your daily life?
4. Why do you think some countries would be exempt from Trump's tariffs?

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3 Listening for specific information

Listen to the report. Tick the items you hear mentioned.

- ☐ politicians
- ☐ economists
- ☐ allies
- ☐ charges
- ☐ loans
- ☐ lawyers
- ☐ goods
- ☐ banks
- ☐ investors
- ☐ companies

4 Listening comprehension

For each question, select the answer that most accurately reflects the information given in the audio. Listen to the report again to check your answers.

1. What did Trump call the day in which he announced global tariffs?

   a. Liberation Day b. Liberal Day c. Liberty Day

2. How many countries will be affected by the tariffs?

   a. around 60 b. around 80 c. around 90

3. Which country is the largest importer of foreign goods in the world?

   a. China
   b. The United States of America
   c. The United Kingdom

4. How much will China now pay in tariffs?

   a. 44% b. 51% c. 54%

5. What do Norfolk Island, Heard Island and the McDonald Islands have in common?

   a. they are all named after fast-food restaurants
   b. they are all uninhabited
   c. they are all home to US military bases

6. Which company lost $300 billion in share value?

   a. Nike b. Amazon c. Apple

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5 Pre-reading task: general vocabulary

You are going to read an article titled, "The start of a global trade war?" in which four members of the public give their opinions on the tariffs. Read the text quickly and find words that match the synonyms and definitions below in each section.

1. _____ (adj., para. 1): basic
2. _____ (n, para. 2): a line of workers and machines in a factory, along which a product passes, having parts made, put together or checked at each stage until the product is finished
3. _____ (v, para. 2): get work done by making a contract with another company to do it, often in another country, rather than in your own company
4. _____ (n, para. 2): a town that used to be busy and have a lot of people living in it, but is now empty
5. _____ (v, para. 3): stop providing money for something, especially something official
6. _____ (adj., para. 3): unfair
7. _____ (adj., para. 4): astonished
8. _____ (n, para. 4): a series of letters, numbers or symbols that represent a rule or law
9. _____ (n, para. 4): a description of a situation, a problem, etc. that is too simple and that ignores some of the facts

The start of a global trade war?

Four members of the public share their opinions.

1. Rosa, 22

Although I'm a student, I have to work as a waitress on the side in order to make ends meet. Financially, things have been tough for everyone I know for a long time – my parents, my friends, my classmates and my colleagues. The price of some staple goods has risen so much that I have to be very careful when planning my weekly budget! I think the last thing that anyone needs – in my country or the world in general – is for prices to go up. Wages aren't increasing, but house prices are. People are still living with their parents in their thirties, unable to break into the housing market. Everyone is fed up with being worried all the time, but it feels like that's just how the world is now. The whole tariff thing just feels completely pointless. Who will it help?

2. Tad, 35

I voted for President Trump because everything was too expensive, and it was getting worse. He's going to make the prices go down and bring manufacturing back to America. My dad worked on the assembly line in one of the major US car companies before he was laid off. The whole factory shut down, and they outsourced production to some countries in Asia. As a result, our city became a ghost town, full of empty buildings. Crime rates increased, and we ended up moving out. I was worried for my daughter's safety. I'm still looking for a job, but I hope that Trump's tariffs will bring work back to the US and that we'll be able to afford the basics again. Maybe even a holiday this year!

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3. **Naomi, 42**

As an aid worker, I've seen some terrible things. I'm in Africa at the moment, but I have colleagues in Myanmar who have described the devastation. Children without homes and buildings completely destroyed. Foreign volunteers make up the majority of aid workers in many organisations. We work with local agencies to ensure a supply of drinking water, hand out garments and arrange temporary accommodation for victims. Under President Trump, USAID, a major humanitarian organisation, has been defunded. Now, the president has announced tariffs that will directly affect many of the countries USAid was offering assistance to, such as Myanmar. This feels cruel and unjust. From my perspective, it's an attack by the most powerful on the most vulnerable.

4. **Marten, 52**

As an economist, I'm astounded. I'm not sure that the American president fully appreciates what he's done – or why he's done it. Some are calling his actions the beginnings of a trade war, which is looking like a distinct possibility. The Trump Administration released a formula, which they claimed explains the tariffs. For each country, the US calculated a percentage based on 2024's trade-in goods deficit, which was divided by the total value of imports, and then halved. In the minds of many of my colleagues, this is a huge oversimplification based on a misunderstanding of trade deficits. The truth of the matter is that American-made products are too expensive for many countries to buy, explaining the larger deficits seen in poorer countries. To then punish these countries seems ridiculous!

Sources: BBC, Independent, The Guardian

6 Reading comprehension

Part A: Read the article again. Match statements with the correct speakers. One of the statements cannot be matched to any of the speakers and should be marked 'Not given'.

Marten **Naomi** **Not given** **Rosa** **Tad**

1. They feel hopeful about the tariffs. → _____
2. They think that the Trump Administration misunderstood the concept of trade deficits. → _____
3. They think that other countries should put tariffs in place too. → _____
4. They think that everyone is tired of worrying all the time. → _____
5. They are worried that the tariffs will affect countries that need assistance. → _____

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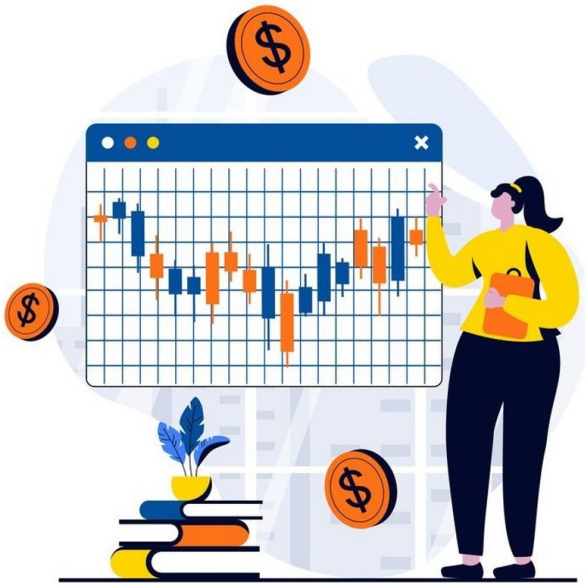
Part B: For each question, choose the answer you believe best suits the speaker.

1. Why does Rosa have to be careful when planning her weekly budget?
   a. Her university fees are very expensive.
   b. The price of basic goods has risen a lot.
   c. She wants to save up so that she can buy her first home.

2. Why did Tad vote for Trump?
   a. He thought that there were too many foreigners moving to the US.
   b. He believed that Trump would help to reduce crime rates in his hometown.
   c. He felt that things were too expensive and was worried that the situation would get worse.

3. How does Naomi feel about the tariffs?
   a. She thinks that they will damage the American economy.
   b. She thinks that they are a good idea in theory, but should be aimed at richer countries.
   c. She believes that they are an attack on the most vulnerable by the most powerful.

4. Why does Marten think that some poorer countries have larger trade deficits with the US?
   a. American-made products are too expensive.
   b. Some countries don't want to buy from the US because of political reasons.
   c. Countries that are at war with the US or its allies are less likely to buy American-made products.



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7 Talking point

In pairs or small groups, discuss the following questions.

1. Do you think Trump's tariffs are a good or bad idea?
2. How do you think the tariffs will affect life for regular people in the US? How will they affect life for people in poorer countries?
3. Should countries manufacture most of their own goods, or does it make sense to import most products?
4. Why do you think Trump decided to pursue global tariffs? What do you believe is his motivation?
5. Do you think your country has a strong economy? If not, how could it become stronger?
6. Do you think that capitalism will survive the twenty-first century? Why/why not?

8 Optional extension

Task A: Write an opinion essay on ONE of the topics below. Your essay should agree with or disagree with the statement and should be between 260 – 320 words.

- We are entering the end times of capitalism. If we want to survive as a species, we need to create a more equal economic system.
- Every country should be able to survive by itself, without needing to import goods or products from abroad.

Task B: Split into groups. Each group is in charge of their own country. The United States has decided to enact new tariffs on every country in the world, with each country receiving a different rate. Your country has been hit with the tariff rate supplied by your teacher. In groups, decide how to respond to the new tariffs. Will you enact retaliatory measures? Will you try to make a deal with the US, or with other countries? Think of possible solutions, before deciding on one course of action for your country. Present your response to the class.

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